THE QUADLENS LESSON CHECKLIST

Four lenses for lessons that really work



Use it to plan a lesson, observe one, or reflect on your own.

1 CLARITY OF LEARNING

Do students know what they are learning, and why?

- [ ] Learning intention planned as Know, Understand, Do (KUD)
- [ ] Success criteria shared, and ideally built with students
- [ ] A model or example shows what good looks like
- [ ] Every task clearly serves the learning intention
- [ ] Students can explain what they are learning, not just what they are doing

2 SUPPORT AND CHALLENGE

Is every student stretched, and supported to succeed?

- [ ] Tasks pitched just beyond what students can already do
- [ ] Scaffolds offered, then gradually removed
- [ ] Stretch ready for students who are ready to go further
- [ ] Targeted support for students who need it, without lowering expectations
- [ ] High expectations are visible for every student

3 COGNITIVE ENGAGEMENT

Who is doing the thinking?

- [ ] Questions demand reasoning and explanation, not just recall
- [ ] Every student responds: think-pair-share, mini whiteboards, cold call
- [ ] Wait time before answers are taken
- [ ] New content chunked to respect working memory
- [ ] Unnecessary task-switching avoided; one clear focus at a time

4 ASSESSMENT FOR LEARNING

How do you know they are learning, right now?

- [ ] Planned checks for understanding at key points
- [ ] Teaching adapted in the moment, based on the evidence
- [ ] Feedback moves learning forward, and students act on it
- [ ] Self- and peer-assessment against the success criteria
- [ ] An exit check informs the next lesson

QUICK REFLECTION

Which lens was strongest today? Which one will I strengthen next lesson, and how?

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